Reading Language Arts · Practice Test 2

Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow. Use evidence from the texts.

Passage 1 — Opening Night (drama)

Backstage at a school theater. PRIYA paces. JAMAL leans against a prop table.

PRIYA: *(pacing)* I can't do this, Jamal. There are a hundred people out there.

JAMAL: A hundred and two. I counted. *(grinning)*

PRIYA: You're not helping.

JAMAL: *(serious)* You've known these lines for a month. You said them in your sleep—your sister texted me.

PRIYA: *(half-laughing)* She did not.

JAMAL: The point is, you're ready. The nerves just mean you care.

(The STAGE MANAGER waves from the wings.)

STAGE MANAGER: Priya—thirty seconds.

PRIYA: *(takes a deep breath)* Okay. Okay. *(She steps toward the light, then turns back.)* Jamal? Thanks.

JAMAL: Break a leg.

(Priya walks onstage. The backstage lights dim as applause rises.)

1. The words in parentheses, such as *(pacing)* and *(grinning)*, are — A. dialogue B. stage directions C. titles D. settings

2. Why does Jamal joke that he counted "a hundred and two" people? A. to frighten Priya B. to lighten her nerves C. to leave the theater D. to brag

3. Priya's pacing and words show that she feels — A. bored B. confident C. nervous D. angry

4. A theme of the scene is that — A. friends help us face our fears B. acting is easy C. counting calms everyone D. plays run too long

5. As used in the scene, "Break a leg" means — A. get hurt B. good luck C. stop now D. run away

6. Which line **best** shows Priya gathering her courage? A. "I can't do this" B. "You're not helping" C. "*(takes a deep breath)* Okay. Okay." D. "There are a hundred people out there"

7. The stage manager's entrance mainly serves to — A. end the play B. move the action toward Priya's entrance C. begin a new conflict D. describe the setting

SCR 1. *(2 points)* How does Jamal help Priya in this scene? Support your answer with **evidence from the text.**

Passage 2 — Phones in School (argument)

(1) Should students use phones during the school day? Many schools say no—and they are right. Phones in class do more harm than good.

(2) First, phones distract. Studies show that students who keep phones nearby check them dozens of times an hour, breaking focus during lessons. Even a buzzing pocket pulls attention away from learning.

(3) Second, phones can harm how students treat one another. Cyberbullying often happens during school hours, and constant texting can crowd out real conversation at lunch.

(4) Some argue that phones are useful for emergencies and research. That is a fair point. But schools already have office phones for emergencies and classroom computers for research. The benefits do not outweigh the costs.

(5) A phone-free school day helps students focus, connect, and learn. For most schools, putting phones away is a smart choice.

8. The author's main **claim** is that — A. phones help learning B. phones should be put away during school C. schools need more computers D. emergencies never happen

9. In paragraph 4, the author brings up the idea that phones help in emergencies in order to — A. agree with it completely B. address and answer the opposing view C. change the subject D. confuse the reader

10. The author's purpose is to — A. entertain with a story B. persuade readers that phones should be put away C. describe a phone D. explain how phones are built

11. Which detail **best** supports the idea that phones distract? A. "schools already have office phones" B. "students check them dozens of times an hour" C. "a phone-free school day" D. "conversation at lunch"

12. This passage is most likely written for — A. toddlers B. school leaders, students, and parents C. scientists only D. airline pilots

13. The author builds the argument mainly by — A. telling a personal story B. giving reasons and answering a counter-argument C. listing dictionary definitions D. using rhyme

14. Which is the **best** summary? A. Phones are fun. B. The author argues phones should be put away during school because they distract and harm relationships, and their benefits can be met in other ways. C. Schools have computers. D. Texting is common.

SCR 2. *(2 points)* According to the author, why should phones be put away during the school day? Use **evidence from the passage.**

Paired Set — Teen Sleep

Text A — "Why Teens Need Sleep"

Teenagers need about 8 to 10 hours of sleep each night, yet most get far less. During puberty, the body's internal clock shifts later, so teens naturally feel awake at night and sleepy in the morning. Sleep helps memory, mood, and health. Without enough, students struggle to focus and remember what they learn.

Text B — "Later Start Times"

Some schools have tried starting classes later in the morning. The results are promising: students report better attendance, higher grades, and fewer car accidents among teen drivers. Sleep experts say a start time of 8:30 a.m. or later fits teens' natural sleep patterns.

15. The main idea of Text A is that — A. teens need enough sleep for health and learning B. teens sleep too much C. clocks are broken D. mornings are the best time to study

16. Text B suggests that later start times — A. hurt grades B. have several benefits for teens C. are impossible to try D. cause more accidents

17. Both texts support the idea that — A. teens need less sleep B. teen sleep affects school success C. schools should start earlier D. sleep does not matter

18. Which idea appears in Text B but **not** in Text A? A. Teens need sleep B. Later start times improve attendance and grades C. Sleep helps memory D. The body clock shifts

19. Text A is organized mainly by — A. explaining a cause (the body clock) and its effects B. telling a story in order C. listing steps D. comparing two schools

20. Both texts are written mainly to — A. entertain B. inform readers about teen sleep C. sell a product D. argue against school

Revising — "A School Garden"

(1) Our class wants to build a school garden. (2) A garden would give us fresh vegetables. (3) It would teach us about science. (4) Working outside is fun. (5) We would need soil, seeds, and tools. (6) With help from teachers, we can make it happen.

21. Which sentence could **best** be added after sentence 3 to develop it with a detail? A. "Science is a subject." B. "For example, we could study how plants grow and measure them each week." C. "I like gardens." D. "Tools are useful."

22. Which transition would **best** begin sentence 4? A. However, B. In addition, C. Because D. Finally,

23. What is the **best** way to combine sentences 2 and 3? A. A garden would give us fresh vegetables, it teaches science. B. A garden would give us fresh vegetables and teach us about science. C. Fresh vegetables and science, a garden. D. A garden, giving vegetables, science.

24. Which sentence **best** states the writer's main idea (thesis)? A. Sentence 1 B. Sentence 4 C. Sentence 5 D. Sentence 6

Editing — "The Field Trip"

> (1) Our class go to the aquarium every year. (2) Last year, me and my friends saw a giant octopus. (3) It's arms were longer than I am tall. (4) We learned alot about ocean animals.

25. What change should be made in sentence 1? A. Change "go" to "goes" B. Change "class" to "classes" C. Change "every" to "ever" D. No change

26. What change should be made in sentence 2? A. Change "me and my friends" to "my friends and I" B. Change "saw" to "seen" C. Change "giant" to "gigantic" D. No change

27. What change should be made in sentence 3? A. Change "It's" to "Its" B. Change "longer" to "long" C. Change "am" to "is" D. No change

28. What change should be made in sentence 4? A. Change "alot" to "a lot" B. Change "learned" to "learn" C. Change "ocean" to "Ocean" D. No change

Extended Constructed Response (ECR) — *(10 points)*

Using **Text A ("Why Teens Need Sleep")** and **Text B ("Later Start Times")**, write a multi-paragraph **informational essay** that explains **why teenagers need enough sleep and how schools could help.** Use evidence from **both** texts. Organize your essay with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion, and use correct grammar and spelling.

Answers and full explanations for this test are in Part 3 · Answer Keys & Explanations.